

Cassava leaves as a vegetable protein and minerals source for human nutrition

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Abstract

Cassava leaves are used as human food in regional dishes or simply as a vegetable in the form of tender shoots, as in Africa. The mature leaves, ground and cooked with meat and spices, are the basis of the dish *maniçoba*, part of the rich cuisine of Pará, a Brazilian state located in the Amazon region of Brazil. The leaves have an adequate protein content for human nutrition but are known to be deficient in essential amino acids. A distinguishing feature is the presence of cyanogenic compounds, lotaustralin and linamarin, which, depending on the type of use, require appropriate processing. Another characteristic of cassava leaves is their high content of phenolic compounds, which are valued when considered bioactive.